

Shreya Nupur Shakya

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

LLM Reasoning and Evaluation; AI Agents; Efficient and Adaptive Reasoning; Multimodal Learning; Multilingual NLP

EDUCATION

University of Arizona

Master of Science in Computer Science, GPA: 3.6/4.0
Graduate Certificate in Natural Language Processing

December 2025
Tucson, AZ

Jain University

Bachelor of Technology in Computer Science and Engineering, CGPA: 9.3/10, Rank: 2/~500

May 2021
Bangalore, India

PUBLICATIONS

- [1] Zijie Wang, Md Mosharaf Hossain, Shivam Mathur, Terry Cruz Melo, Kadir Bulut Ozler, Keun Hee Park, Jacob Quintero, MohammadHossein Rezaei, **Shreya Nupur Shakya**, Md Nayem Uddin, and Eduardo Blanco. 2023. Interpreting Indirect Answers to Yes-No Questions in Multiple Languages . In **Findings of the Association for Computational Linguistics: EMNLP 2023**, pages 2210–2227.
- [2] Shashikala H. K., **Shreya Nupur Shakya**, Pooja Panjiyar, Abhinav Singh Upreti, and Shaik Dadapeer. 2022. Attendance Monitoring System Using Face Recognition . **International Journal of Information Technology, Research and Applications**, 1(3), 15–22.
- [3] Shashikala H. K., **Shreya Nupur Shakya**, Pooja Panjiyar, Abhinav Singh Upreti, and Shaik Dadapeer. 2020. Survey on Iris Based Recognition Systems . **IJSHRE**, Vol. 8, Issue 12, pp. 59–62.

SELECTED RESEARCH PROJECTS

Minimal Chain-of-Thought Reasoning in Low-Resource Languages

LING 582 – Advanced Statistical Natural Language Processing, University of Arizona | 2025

- Studied whether shorter reasoning traces can preserve LLM reasoning performance in a low-resource language while reducing inference cost.
- Compared No-CoT, Minimal-CoT, and Standard-CoT using Llama-3-8B-Instruct and Qwen2.5-7B-Instruct across English and Nepali mathematical reasoning, measuring accuracy, token usage, and inference time.
- Found that Minimal-CoT retained approximately 95–100% of Standard-CoT accuracy in three of four model–language settings while using 68–81% of its token budget; analyzed failures involving truncation, semantic grounding, reasoning drift, and repetition.

Further Pre-training RoBERTa for Negation in Neural Information Retrieval

CSC 583 – Text Retrieval and Web Search, University of Arizona | 2025

- Examined whether negation-specific further pre-training improves neural retrievers' sensitivity to semantic negation.
- Evaluated RoBERTa-large on NevIR under no-supervision and fine-tuning settings, comparing negation-focused pre-training methods including NSP, NSPP, and commonsense-based objectives.
- Achieved a state-of-the-art NevIR score of 80.8 with NSP-pretrained RoBERTa-large after fine-tuning, outperforming the reported RankGPT o3-mini result by 3.5 points; error analysis identified persistent failures in recognizing negation.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

University of Arizona

Research Contributor – Interpreting Indirect Answers to Yes-No Questions in Multiple Languages

Advisor: Dr. Eduardo Blanco

- Contributed to research on multilingual pragmatic language understanding, focusing on how indirect answers to yes–no questions are interpreted across languages.

- Created and validated Nepali language data using native-language judgments of context-dependent answers and supported evaluation of cross-lingual transfer across eight languages.
- Co-authored the resulting work published in *Findings of EMNLP 2023*.

University of Arizona

Research Contributor – *SexTok*

Advisor: Dr. Mihai Surdeanu

- Supported development of a 1,000-video multimodal dataset for distinguishing sex-educational, sexually suggestive, and other TikTok content.
- Annotated context-sensitive social-media content using visual and linguistic cues to support multimodal content classification.
- Recognized in the acknowledgements of the resulting *Findings of ACL 2023* paper for data annotation contributions.

University of Arizona

Graduate Research Assistant

Fall 2021

Advisor: Dr. Katherine E. Isaacs

- Explored visualization methods for understanding compiler optimization behavior through static and dynamic program analysis.
- Developed an interactive visualization system using Dyninst APIs and D3.js to expose code-optimization behavior and support analysis of program transformations.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

University of Arizona

Course Instructor, Department of Computer Science

2022 – 2025

Tucson, AZ

- Independently led undergraduate courses in Software Development and Web Programming, delivering lectures and hands-on instruction in programming, software engineering, and web technologies.
- Designed assignments, assessments, and grading rubrics; evaluated student performance and held office hours.
- **CSC 210 – Software Development** Summer 2025
- **CSC 337 – Web Programming** Summer 2023, Summer 2022

University of Arizona

Graduate Teaching Assistant, Department of Computer Science

2022 – 2025

Tucson, AZ

- Assisted instructors with course administration and assessment, including setting up Gradescope and D2L, organizing grading workflows, holding office hours, and contributing to grading rubrics when needed.
- **CSC 337 – Web Programming** Fall 2025, Spring 2022
- **CSC 346 – Cloud Computing** Spring 2025
- **CSC 452 – Operating Systems** Fall 2023, Fall 2022
- **CSC 483/583 – Text Retrieval and Web Search** Spring 2023

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming: Python, Java, C/C++, SQL, JavaScript

ML/NLP Libraries: PyTorch, TensorFlow, Hugging Face Transformers, scikit-learn

Tools/Platforms: Git, Docker, Linux, Jupyter

Databases: PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB